Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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0 Contents

1 Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRPsystem and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator

Part I

The System

2 The Basics

ΓRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character– a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. ΓRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.

The fundamental dice mechanic in ΓRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain a few dozen 12 sided dice.

2.1 The Fundamental Dice Mechanic

The notation for a roll in ΓRP is written as RXaY, which verbally is pronounced as "Roll X a Y"

X is the number of dice you roll.

Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top Y numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success.

This means that both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.

Higher Y mean the roll is successful even at lower thresholds. An advantage of 1 is the default when advantage is not specified. This means that is only successful on a 12. However an advantage of 2 means the roll is successful on any instance of a 12 or an 11 (there are two numbers now on which the roll is successful).

Let's look at a few example rolls.

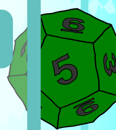

Table 2.1a: Advantage Examples

Roll	Dice	Result
R5a1	1 11 8 4 10	Failure
R5a1	1 1 2 **12** 2	Success
R4a1	1 11 8 10	Failure
R4a2	1 **11** 8 10	Success
R4a3	1 **11** 8 **10**	Success
R3a3	1 9 8	Failure
R3a4	1 **9** 8	Success
R3a8	2 4 3	Failure
R3a9	2 **4** 3	Success

Another way to look at this is– if you

can sum the advantage with the value of any die in your roll and get a number greater than 12, your roll is successful. An advantage of 0 is the exception, which still is successful if any dice rolls a 12.

An advantage of 12 means that any roll with at least 1 die automatically succeeds, as the threshold for success is 1. You can simply declare a success if you are asked to make a roll with an advantage of 12, but you may still make the roll if you have any abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Some rolls will ask you to count the number of successes in your roll. In any roll with advantage, you simply count the number of dice that pass the success threshold.

Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvantage* which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of R*X*a*(-Z)* is written equivalently as R*X*d*Z*.

A roll with at *disadvantage* of *Z* means that in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least *Z* dice within the roll displaying a number above 1. For example, with a roll of R4d2, 1 die must land on 12, and one of the other dice must show a value above 1, so that a total of 2 dice including the one showing "12" are displaying values above 1.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2.1b: Disadvantage Examples

Roll	Dice	Result
R2d1	12_1 2_2	Success
R2d1	12_1 1	Success
R2d2	12_1 1	Failure
R4d1	11 8 1 10	Failure
R4d2	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Success
R4d3	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Success
R4d4	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Failure
R8d7	12_1 12_2 1 12_3 12_4 12_5 12_6 1	Failure
R2d1	12_1 2_2	Success
R2d1	12_1 1	Success
R2d2	12_1 1	Failure
R4d1	11 8 1 10	Failure
R4d2	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Success
R4d3	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Success
R4d4	12_1 8_2 1 10_3	Failure
R8d7	12_1 12_2 1 12_3 12_4 12_5 12_6 1	Failure

Another way to think about disadvantage rolls is– if you've rolled at least one 12, and if you can count a number of dice showing a value above 1 equal to or greater than the disadvantage, your roll is a success.

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. This is because you cannot obtain a sufficient number of dice showing values above 1. Additionally, any roll with a disadvantage 12 or greater automatically fails, for symmetry with the advantage rolls (where any roll with an advantage 12 or greater automatically succeeds) If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice, you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

For rolls that require you to count the number of successes, any successful disadvantaged roll provides 1 success. Any failed disadvantaged roll provides no successes.

Note that the rolls RXa1, RXa0, and RXd1 are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

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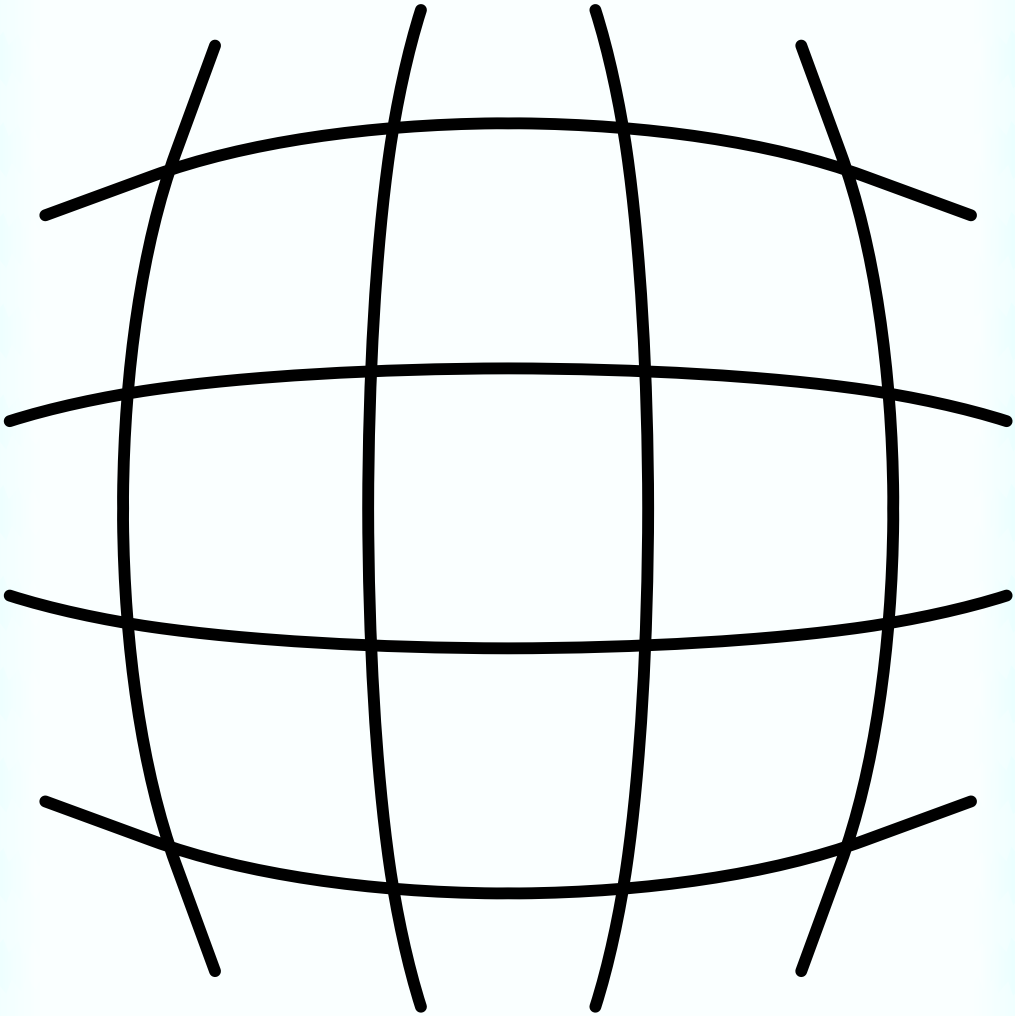

Table 2.1a: Test of the GRPfigure environment

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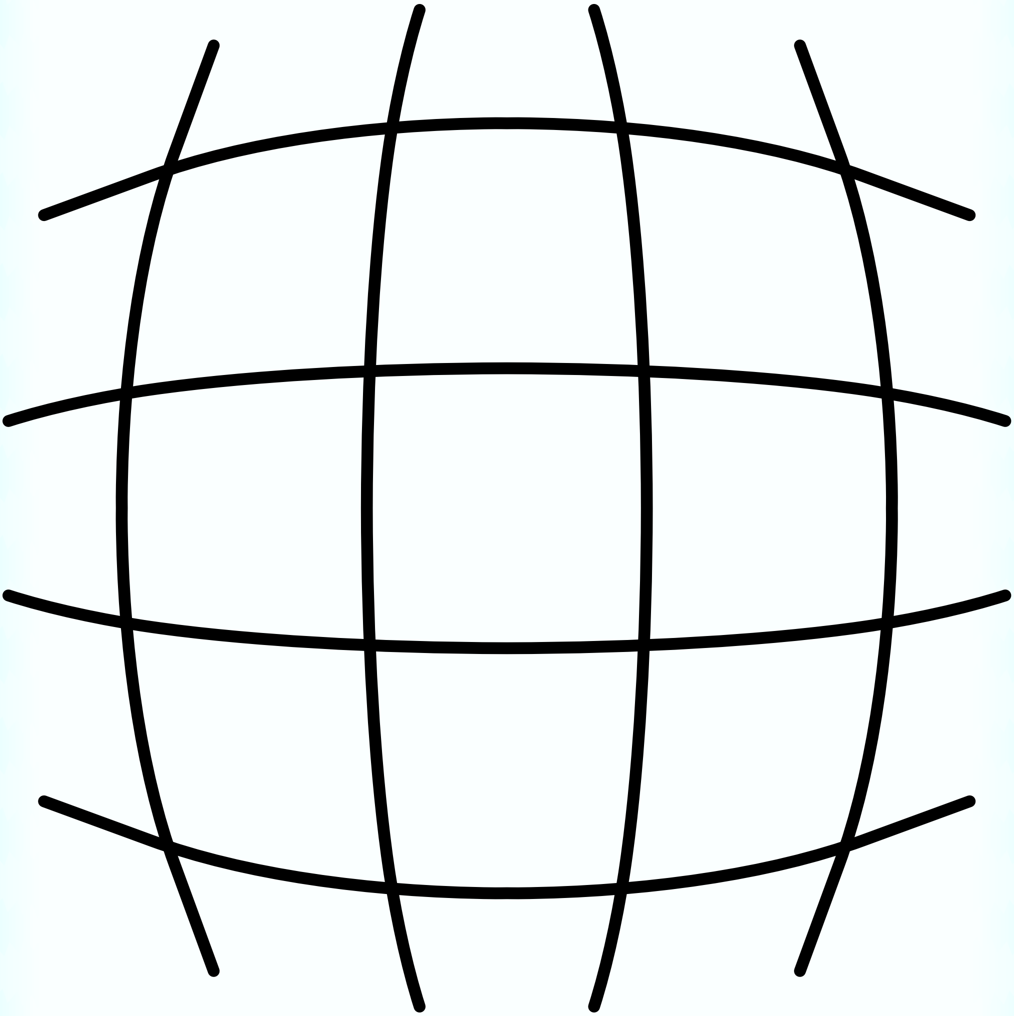

Table 2.1b: Another test of the GRPfigure environment

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Part II

The Setting

Part III

Appendices

List of Figures

List of Tables

Alphabetical Index